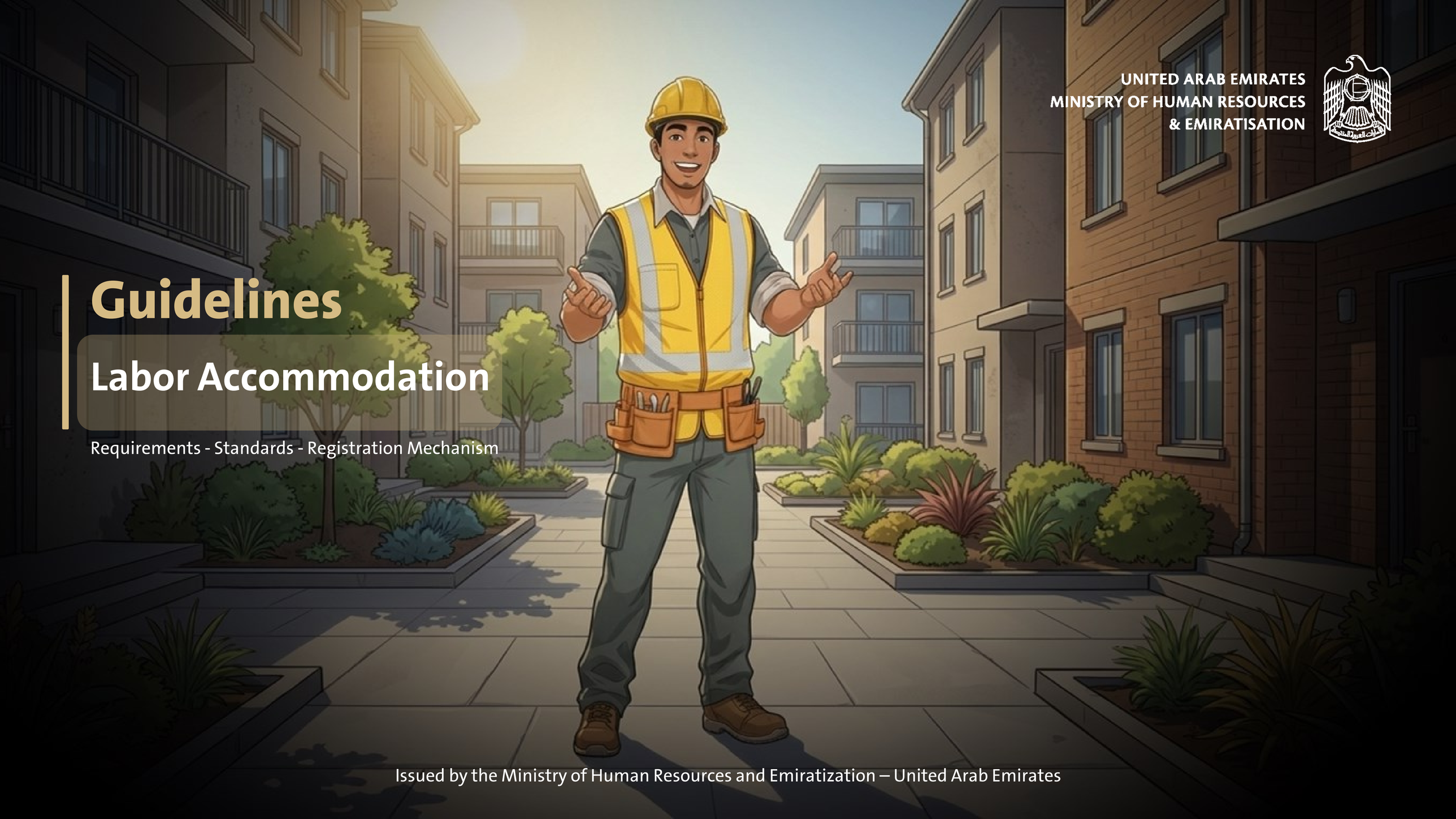

UNITED ARAB EMIRATES
MINISTRY OF HUMAN RESOURCES
& EMIRATISATION

Guidelines

Labor Accommodation

Requirements - Standards - Registration Mechanism

Issued by the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization – United Arab Emirates

Introduction:

Through this introductory booklet for the labor accommodation system, we provide you with comprehensive guidelines that indicate such adopted standards and requirements, as well as the registration mechanism for the labor accommodation system at the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation, in order to ensure the provision of a safe, healthy, and stable environment for workers.

First:
Requirements for Labor Accommodation

As an employer, you shall provide suitable accommodation licensed by the competent authorities for the worker, in accordance with the rules, standards, and resolutions in force in the State; or to pay a cash housing allowance; or to include the cost of housing within the wage.

In the event that your establishment employs 50 or more workers, each of whom earns a wage of AED 1,500 or less, you shall provide labor accommodation and ensure that such accommodation is regularly compliant with the applicable requirements and standards.

Second:
Standards for Labor Accommodation

Site Standards

Issuance of such required permits

from all relevant government authorities for the utilization of the property (as labor accommodation), including, but not limited to:

- Local municipal departments across the State.
- Departments of planning, surveying, lands, and properties.
- Civil defense directorates.
- Water and electricity companies.
- Authorities concerned with licensing and supervision.

It shall be distant from:

- Residential family areas (no less than 5 km).
- Sources of environmental pollution.
- Rainwater and flood drainage channels.

It shall be in proximity to:

- Industrial areas.
- Effective road networks.

Lighting:

All installed lighting units in occupied areas and throughout the units shall meet the minimum illumination levels as determined based on safety considerations.

All lamps shall be of a low-energy consumption type. Moreover, such lamps placed in recesses shall be utilized when installing suspended ceilings.

Outdoor lighting levels shall enable pedestrians to clearly identify the boundaries of walkways, changes in direction, walkway intersections, and any potential obstacles or hazards.

Street crossings, changes in street gradients, and any other potentially hazardous locations shall be illuminated with a higher level of illumination than the walkways.

Lighting poles/columns shall be placed in a manner that does not impede pedestrian movement.

Ventilation and Air Conditioning:

An air extraction system shall be installed in the bathrooms to discharge air outside the building.

- Rooms, kitchens, dining halls, corridors, offices, and halls shall be equipped with central ventilation and air conditioning systems in accordance with the standards and conditions adopted by the local competent authorities. In the absence of central air conditioning, the rooms shall be equipped with individual air conditioning units.
- A window with curved louvers made of aluminum for ventilation shall be installed at a low level in the door of each bedroom or bathroom to provide ventilation.
- The quality of indoor air in the building shall be maintained and supplied with outdoor air in accordance with the adopted rates.

- Adequate ventilation systems shall be provided in bathrooms, storage rooms, linen rooms, computer rooms, kitchens, lavatories, ovens, changing/showering rooms, swimming pools, as well as other areas containing sources of pollution.
- A system to control temperature, humidity, and air velocity shall be provided in order to ensure a comfortable environment, fulfill requirements, and reduce microbes and pollutants in all air-conditioned spaces.
- The relative humidity shall range between 30% and 60% in all air-conditioned areas

Bedrooms and Their Annexes:

- The ceiling height shall not be less than 7 feet (2.1 m).
- Each person shall be provided with a designated sleeping space, even in the case of shifts.
- A bed, a side table, and a 2-meter high wardrobe equipped with a lock shall be provided for each person, ensuring their replacement in case of wear.
- The cleanliness of bed linens and pillows shall be ensured.
- Curtains shall be provided for the windows
- The use of triple-decker beds shall not be used.
- Shoe racks shall be placed at the entrance of each room (on the exterior side).
- Washing and cooking inside the rooms shall be prohibited.
- No flammable materials shall be entered into the bedrooms.
- Sufficient lockers shall be provided for each worker.

Sanitary Facilities:

Showering facilities shall be provided in a number that corresponds to the number of workers residing in the accommodation.

Handwashing sinks shall be provided in a number that corresponds to the number of workers residing in the accommodation.

The provision of water cooling and water heating means shall be ensured throughout the year, with the provision of mixing valves.

Bathroom supplies, including clothes and towel hooks, soap, mirrors, storage cabinets, toilet paper, etc., shall be provided in quantities sufficient for the number of users.

Cleanliness shall be maintained at all times. Cleaning shall be carried out no less than once per day.

Kitchens, Dining Halls, and Lounges:

Each residential unit shall be equipped with a kitchen that complies with the public health standards stipulated by the competent authorities.

Dining halls shall be equipped to accommodate the number of workers residing therein.

The kitchen shall be managed by a licensed food services company, by the food team of the accommodation management, or the kitchen shall be equipped for self-use by the workers.

The conditions and standards for gas extensions shall be fulfilled in accordance with such requirements of the competent authorities.

Comfortable seating and a television set shall be provided for the lounges.

The cleanliness of the kitchen and dining hall shall be maintained at all times. In addition, the kitchen and dining hall shall be provided with pest control means.

The dining hall shall be located near the kitchen. It shall be equipped with all the following supplies: (tables, chairs, a drinking water refrigerator, a handwashing facility, soap, tissues).

Clean and cold drinking water shall be provided in a quantity that corresponds to the number of workers. Moreover, it shall be ensured that water coolers are distributed throughout all areas of the accommodation.

Shopping stores shall be available within the vicinity of the accommodation to provide basic food items for cooking (and in the absence of such stores, the establishment shall provide meals that ensure healthy nutrition for the workers).

The Laundry:

Laundry services shall be provided according to an announced schedule. In addition, a person shall be appointed to be responsible for managing the said services, or the unit shall be provided with shared laundry facilities.

Shared laundry facilities shall be located on the ground floor of the residential unit.

Shared laundries shall be designed in accordance with the technical requirements of the competent authority.

The shared laundry shall be equipped with all supplies, such as washing machines, in a number that corresponds to the number of workers in the accommodation, while ensuring their periodic maintenance.

In the event that the above requirements cannot be met, the laundry process may be outsourced to an external company.

Medical Services:

A first aid room shall be provided and equipped with furniture, equipment, and a medicine storage box.

Isolation rooms shall be provided in a number that corresponds to the number of occupants. However, the said isolation rooms shall be equipped with adequate furniture, equipment, and a private bathroom.

(Accommodation that houses 1,000 or more workers) shall have an on-site medical clinic. The said on-site medical clinic shall be equipped to operate 24 hours a day, seven days a week. In addition, it shall meet the following specifications:

- Ease of access, and be provided with ramps if necessary.
- Provision of a waiting area for patients and appropriately sized rooms/offices.
- Appointment of a sufficient number of staff, including a rotating physician and a nurse.
- Allocation of an ambulance.
- A plan or guide concerning the implementation of precautionary measures to combat the spread of diseases in the building shall be in place.

Public Health:

Waste and Cleanliness:

The waste disposal mechanism shall fulfill such conditions set by the competent authority.

A sufficient number of tightly sealed trash containers shall be provided. Such trash containers shall be emptied and cleaned daily.

The accommodation shall be cleaned on a daily basis.

A contract shall be made with a company specializing in cleaning the accommodation facilities. However, the said company shall be licensed by the competent authority.

Public Health Pests:

A periodic contract shall be made with a company specializing in pest control. However, the said company shall be licensed by the competent authority.

All effective measures shall be taken to prevent the presence or proliferation of pests such as insects and rodents.

Other Services:

- A barbershop, a grocery store (which shall stock basic food items for cooking) to serve the residents only, and places of worship shall be provided.
- The accommodation shall be supplied with water, electricity, sanitation, and gas.
- Fire systems shall be as per the requirements of the competent authorities.
- Food items shall be stored in sealed containers to ensure they are not exposed to spoilage or insects.
- Prepared spaces for practicing light physical and sports activities, such as open yards or multi-purpose facilities, shall be provided.
- The structural integrity of the buildings shall be ensured, free from cracks or any structural hazards in the walls or ceilings.
- A contract shall be made with a specialized company for the periodic cleaning of the accommodation facilities.

Accommodation that houses 1,000 or more workers: Various sports courts and financial service machines shall be provided.

Mobility and Movement:

Adequate space for safe pedestrian movement shall be provided, with the placement of directional signs and the provision of sufficient waiting areas at bus stops and vehicle parking for workers to board and assemble after disembarking.

Adequate space for vehicle movement shall be provided, taking into account the following:

- Entry and exit points.
- Parking of buses and cars.
- Fire prevention and alarm systems.
- The accessibility of emergency vehicles to all buildings.
- The delivery, securing, and storage of food.
- Emergency exits and assembly points.
- Waste management.
- Exterior lighting

The accommodation management shall ensure the provision of an environment suitable for the residency of persons with disabilities (people of determination, injured workers).

A sufficient number of electric elevators shall be provided, in proportion to the number of floors, as well as the number of workers in the accommodation.

Health, Safety, and Security:

Employees, workers, or visitors shall not use smoking products except in designated areas or outdoor areas, provided that they maintain a distance of 20 feet (6 m) from the perimeter of any entrance or air intake vent.

A contract shall be made with a licensed company to provide guarding and security services.

A sufficient number of supervisors shall be provided around the clock.

Compliance with the requirements of the Civil Defense shall be continuously ensured, such as: (the integrity of exits, fire systems, extinguishers, hoses, alarm devices, sensors).

For the accommodation that houses 1,000 or more workers:

- The accommodation shall be equipped with a security system for the surveillance of all its parts.
- The ability to control electricity and water from outside the accommodation shall be ensured.

Accommodation Management:

The accommodation management shall provide:

- A plan or guide concerning the implementation of precautionary measures to combat the spread of diseases in the building.
- A detailed guide that outlines clear emergency plans and training for workers on evacuation procedures.
- Free internet network coverage for all accommodation facilities.
- A clear mechanism or forms for receiving and archiving complaints in a manner that ensures confidentiality.
- A commitment to organizing recreational events for the residents during official holidays.

The Accommodation Manager shall undertake the following:

- Coordinate communication between the accommodation management and third parties (Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation, Police, and the Civil Defense Authority).
- Appoint a sufficient number of employees/workers within the labor accommodation, commensurate with such capacity of the accommodation, and provide them with the appropriate training.
- Provide all the aforementioned services and standards.
- Coordinate inspection operations on all units while monitoring and managing the actual occupancy rate against the planned rate.
- Issue instructions and follow up on periodic maintenance, cleaning activities, catering, food provision, and facility management.
- Ensure the adherence of employees, contractors, and occupants to the regulations established for the accommodation.
- Manage all accommodation facilities in a safe and effective manner in accordance with the aforementioned standards and procedures.
- Maintain records of residents within an updated database.

Awareness and Guidance:

The Accommodation Manager shall develop an awareness program and ensure the enrollment of all residents in said program. The said program shall include the following:

- Pollution reduction.
- Accommodation management instructions and house rules.
- Personal hygiene, waste disposal mechanism, and pest control.
- Fire prevention measures, use of firefighting equipment, identification of responsible personnel in such emergency situations, as well as the conduct of periodic emergency evacuation drills.

Large, clearly visible posters outlining the house rules shall be placed on each floor, in the predominant language of the occupants of the accommodation. The house rules shall include, as a minimum, the following points:

- Cleanliness and waste disposal.
- Loud music.
- Clear prohibitions (smoking, cooking in rooms, etc.).
- Tampering with accommodation equipment.
- Storage mechanism.
- Conservation of water and electricity.
- Visitor reception mechanism.
- Any other matter the Manager deems appropriate.

The Accommodation Management shall provide the following:

- Guidelines regarding such rights and duties of workers in the languages of the workers present in the accommodation.
- Occupational health and safety instructions and guidelines in the languages of the workers present in the accommodation.
- Signs with contact numbers for emergency or for submitting complaints and suggestions to all concerned government authorities.

Note:

The accommodation management, security office, worker supply room, kitchens, dining halls, prayer room, first aid room, and any other services shall be located on the ground floor.

To view all labor accommodation standards (scan the following code)

Classification of Violations

Harm Level	High Risk / Severe Harm	Medium Risk / Potential Harm	Low Risk
Assessment Method	A direct risk to life or health, or an explicit violation of the law.	Regulatory or structural violations that could pose a risk in the medium term; however, they require rectification.	Minor violations that do not affect safety in the short term; however, they require rectification.

Classification of Violations

Harm Level	High Risk / Severe Harm
Assessment Method	A direct risk to life or health, or an explicit violation of the law.

Examples:

- Absence of electricity.
- Expired safety certificate issued by the Civil Defense.
- Confiscation of such passports of the workers.
- Storage of flammable materials inside accommodation rooms or in areas not designated for the said purpose.
- Lack of clean, usable water (cold drinking water shall be provided in a quantity that corresponds to the number of workers; one water cooler per 30 workers, with a capacity of no less than 35 gallons, and it shall be ensured that the coolers are distributed throughout all areas of the accommodation).
- Damaged sewage networks or leakage of sewage water inside the accommodation.
- Malfunctions in toilets that render the toilets unusable or broken, thereby causing environmental pollution.
- Presence of cooking tools in the rooms, which allows for the preparation of food in the rooms.
- Malfunctioning air conditioners or inadequate ventilation.
- Exposed or randomly installed electrical wiring that constitutes a risk of electric shock or fire.
- Exceeding the permitted number of workers in a room (severe overcrowding).
- Failure to provide a bed for each worker (sleeping on the floor).
- Presence of insect or rodent infestations with no treatment.
- Poor ventilation in the corridors, which causes suffocation or creates an uninhabitable environment.
- Absence of/difficulty in accessing and using first aid boxes.
- Lack of cleanliness (in rooms, corridors, laundry rooms, kitchens, or toilets).
- Ineffective ventilation in the kitchen.
- Wires, plugs, and gas pipes that are not compliant with standards.
- Failure to provide a sufficient number of supervisors around the clock.
- Failure to provide security guards around the clock by a licensed company.
- Absence or malfunction of firefighting systems (extinguishers - hoses - alarms - sensors).
- Absence of emergency exits or their being locked/obstructed.
- Presence of cracks or a structural hazard in the walls or ceilings.
- Absence of an equipped clinic in the accommodation.

Classification of Violations

Harm Level	High Risk / Severe Harm
Assessment Method	Regulatory or structural violations that could pose a risk in the medium term; however, they require rectification.

Examples:

- Lack of cleanliness of bed linens and pillows.
- Lack of isolation rooms for individuals with infectious diseases or workers who are temporarily ill.
- Confiscation of such passports of the workers.
- A system for waste collection and sanitation that is safe (bi-weekly).
- Absence of a ramp for the entrance and sidewalks leading to the buildings that would allow for easy access for injured persons.
- Lack of free internet service provided by the accommodation management that covers all accommodation facilities.
- Improper storage of food items (uncovered – not separated).
- Failure to contract with a specialized company for the periodic cleaning of accommodation facilities.
- Minor water leaks from the ceiling or walls.
- Absence of facilities designated for People of Determination in the accommodation.
- Use of cooking or gas appliances that are not subject to maintenance.
- The number of bathrooms is not commensurate with the number of workers in the accommodation, as well as the dining rooms.
- Furniture is old or moderately damaged (personal belongings lockers for workers in the rooms require improvement).

Classification of Violations

Harm Level	Low Risk
Assessment Method	Minor violations that do not affect safety in the short term; however, they require rectification.

Examples:

- Inadequate lighting or burnt-out lamps.
- Absence of safety and evacuation guideline signage.
- Absence of guidelines for the use of firefighting equipment.
- Failure to provide guidelines regarding the rights and duties of workers in the languages of the workers present in the accommodation.
- Failure to provide occupational health and safety instructions and guidelines in the languages of the workers present in the accommodation.
- Lack of instructional posters, evacuation signs, or an error in the accommodation information.
- Absence of a prayer room for a specific group.
- Minor disorder in the arrangement of items within the rooms.
- Failure to provide sufficient lockers for each worker.
- Windows or doors requiring minor repair.
- Failure to clearly display emergency numbers.
- Absence of signs indicating the methods for submitting complaints to other bodies, such as the Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation.
- Absence of regulatory and awareness notices and instructional signs for emergencies posted in the accommodation areas.
- Absence of a maintenance contract with a specialized company to ensure the periodic maintenance of all facilities in the accommodation, including, but not limited to: (rooms, bathrooms, kitchens, elevators, water coolers, air conditioners, etc.).
- Lack of curtains, resulting in reduced privacy for workers and an uncomfortable, overcrowded environment.
- Malfunctions in laundry equipment.
- Absence of a plan or guide concerning the implementation of precautionary measures to combat the spread of diseases in the building.
- The number of electric elevators is not commensurate with the number of floors and the number of workers in the accommodation.
- Absence of shopping stores within the vicinity of the accommodation to provide basic food items for cooking (and in the absence of such stores, the establishment shall provide meals that ensure healthy nutrition for the workers).
- Absence of a detailed guide indicating clear emergency plans or regular training for workers on evacuation procedures.
- Absence of external sports courts.
- Absence of a clear mechanism or forms for receiving and archiving complaints in a manner that ensures confidentiality.
- The dining hall does not have sufficient capacity for the total number of workers.
- Minor wear and tear on the furniture without functional impact.

Mechanisms for Registering

Labor Accommodation and Managing Workers in such Adopted Systems of the Ministry (The Labor Accommodation System)

Accommodation Owner:

The key documents required for the accommodation owner:
an accommodation contract licensed by the concerned local authority; a letter from the concerned authority in case of specific types of accommodation, such as governmental letters/oil sites; a navigation license; a certificate of fulfillment of preventive safety requirements issued by the General Directorate of Civil Defense; an electricity bill from one of the water and electricity distribution companies; a permit issued by the Abu Dhabi Agriculture and Food Safety Authority "for Abu Dhabi accommodations only"; a cleaning service contract and a pest control contract for the accommodation; as well as the commercial licenses that prove the authorization to practice the activity.

Establishment Owner:

Log into the system and select the approved accommodation in accordance with such needs of the company.

Registration Link

600590000

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